

# Hollywood Loves WoMEN... Right?

What the Bechdel Test Reveals About Budgets, Profitability, and Gender Bias

## Key Insight:

Films that pass the Bechdel Test earn 2.8× higher ROI — despite receiving significantly lower budgets.

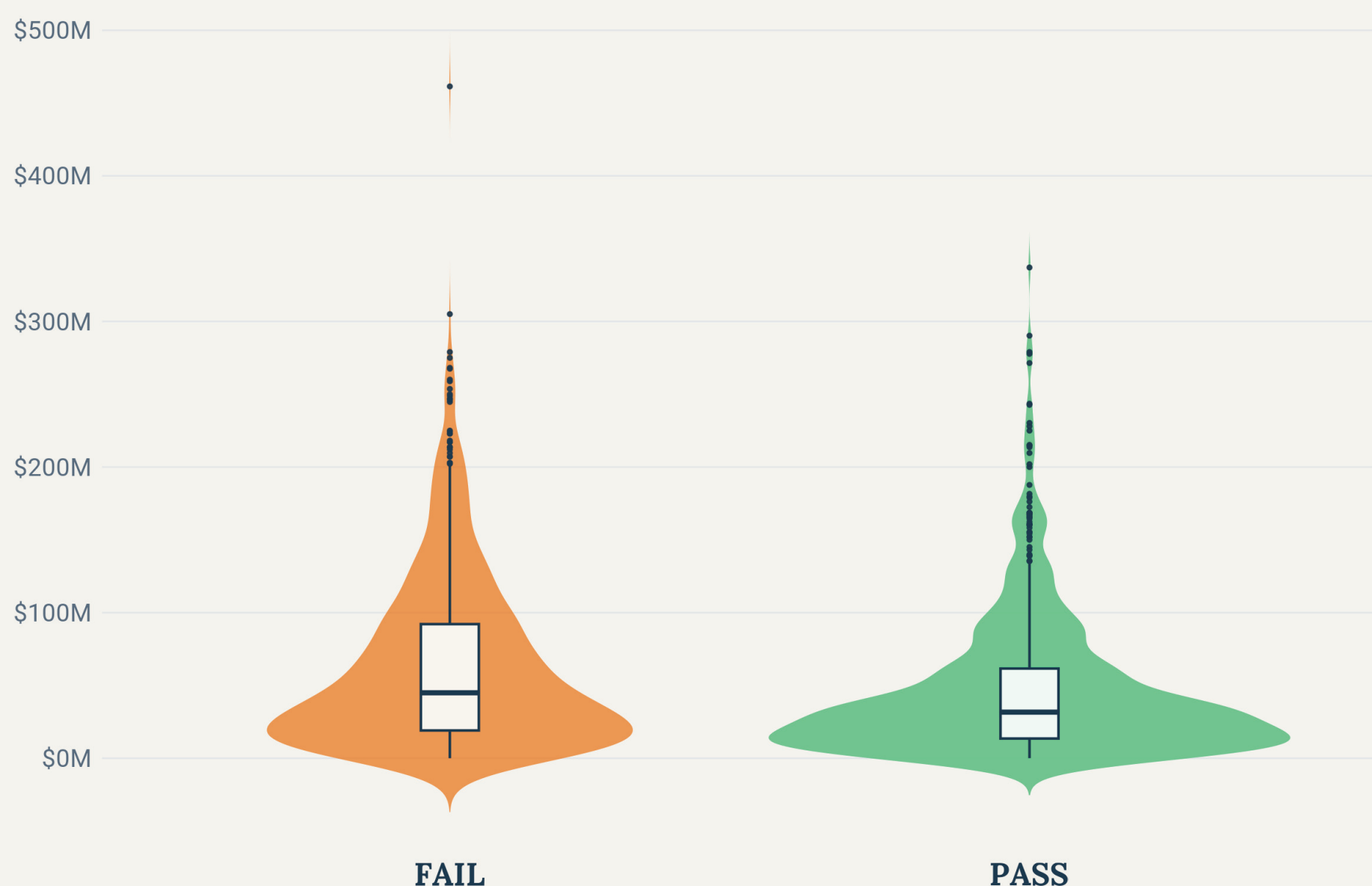
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### The Budget Gap

Films passing receive systematically lower budgets



### The Profitability Paradox

Return on Investment by genre

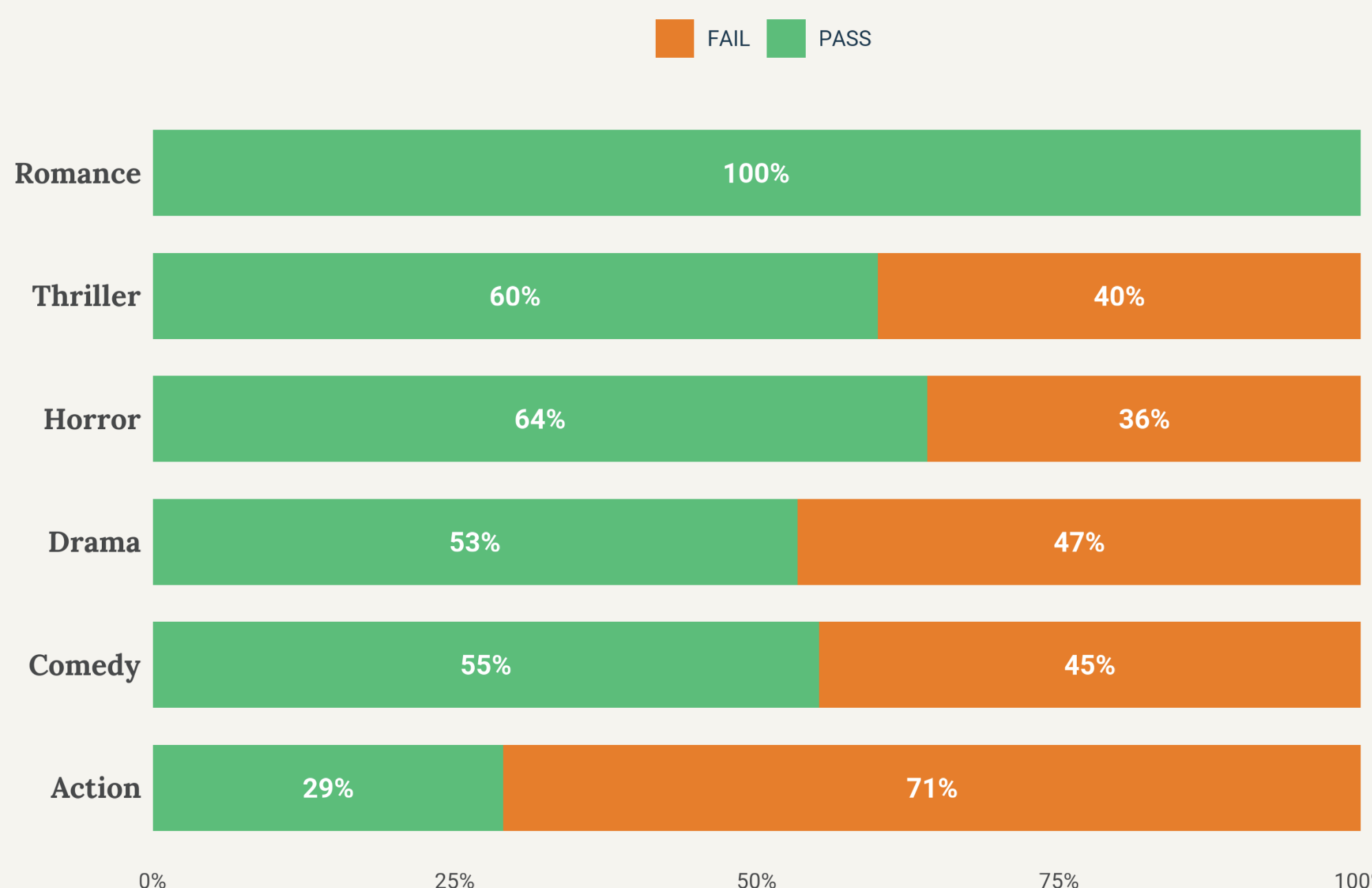


Films that fail the Bechdel Test receive consistently higher budgets, despite no clear financial advantage.

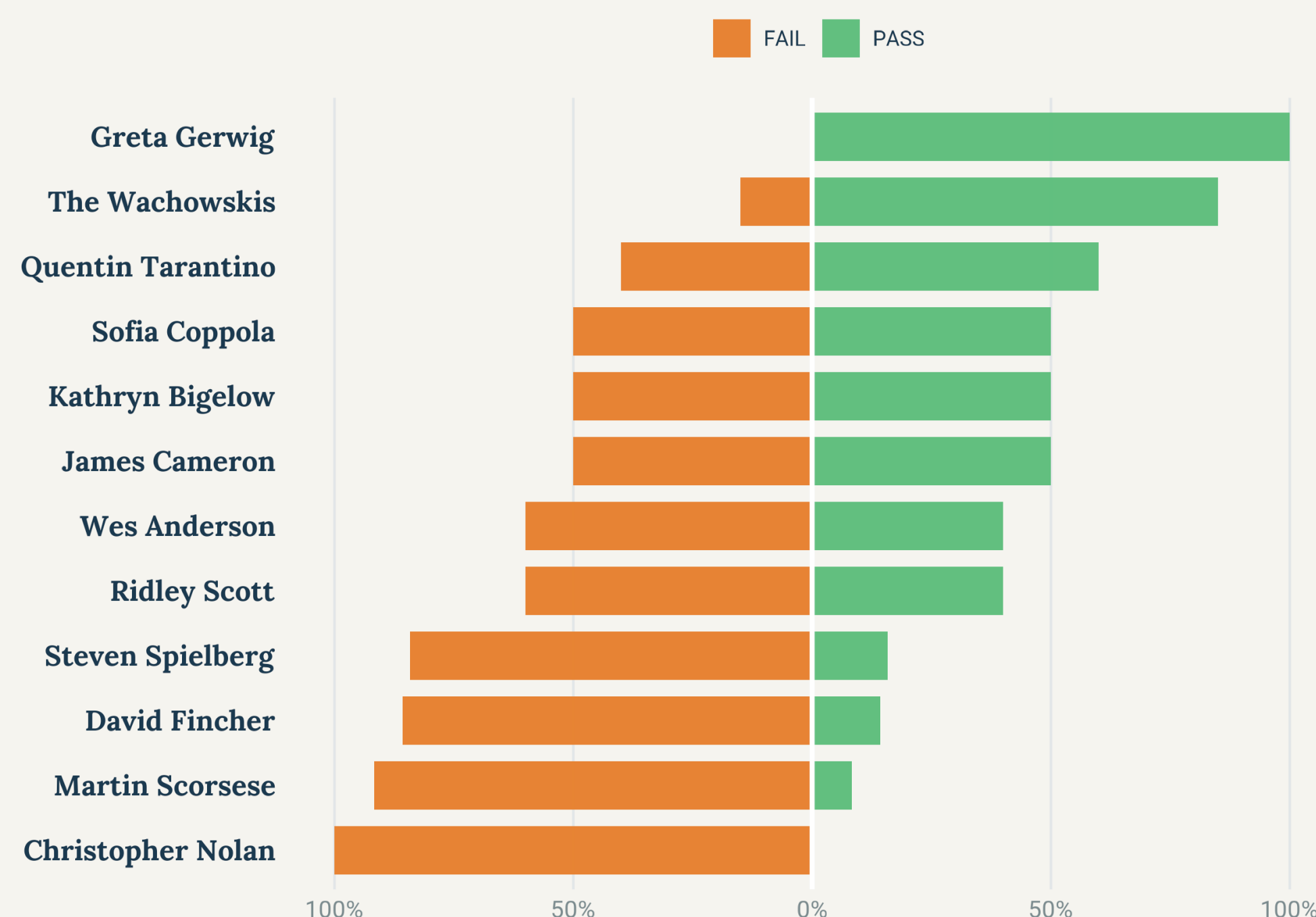
Across nearly all genres, films passing the Bechdel Test achieve equal or higher ROI despite smaller budgets.

### Cinema's Genre DNA

Pass rates by genre



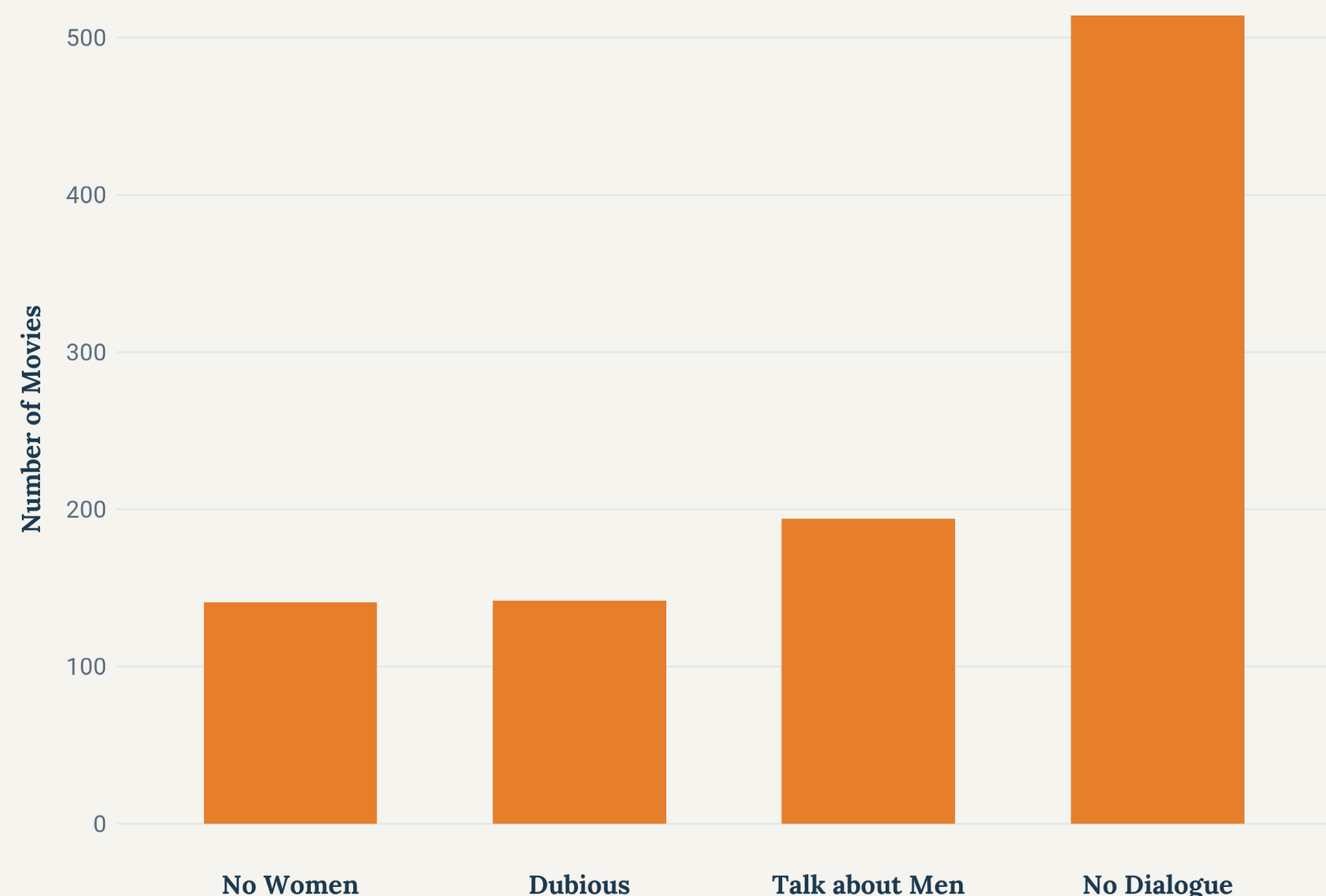
### Directors' Scorecards



The proportion of films passing the Bechdel Test differs by genre, suggesting genre-specific representation dynamics

Bechdel Test outcomes vary across directors, with some of the most prominent figures in mainstream cinema showing lower pass rates..

### The Anatomy of Failure



Most films fail not due to the absence of women, but because women are rarely given meaningful dialogue beyond male-centered narratives.

Data source:

FiveThirtyEight Bechdel Test Database (1970–2013)